

CheckScan Desktop — Project Summary

Overview

CheckScan Desktop is a personal desktop application built to make processing donation checks fast and organized. Instead of manually reading and logging each check by hand, the app scans them, automatically reads the key details off each one, and keeps an organized, running record tied to the fundraiser who brought each check in.

It's built for a single person, on a single Windows computer — a personal tool, not a shared or multi-user system.

How it works

Place the check in the scanner and start a scan. The app captures an image of the check.

Automatic reading. That image is sent to an AI service, which does its best to read back the check's date, amount, issuing bank, routing number, account number, check number, and donor/payer name.

A list of results. Once scanning is done, the app presents a list of every check just scanned, with those details already filled in.

Assign a fundraiser. For each check in the list, you select who brought it in, from a saved roster of fundraisers.

Review and confirm. You check the auto-filled details are correct — fixing anything that looks wrong — then confirm.

Saved. The check becomes part of that fundraiser's permanent history in the app.

Data extraction and accuracy

The app will try to extract as much as it reliably can from each check: **date, amount, bank, routing number, account number, check number, and donor/payer name.**

For the AI reading component, we tested both Anthropic's and OpenAI's models against real checks. Anthropic showed a high level of accuracy in that testing, while OpenAI's results weren't as strong. Based on that, the app will use Anthropic for reading check details.

AI-based reading isn't perfect, especially on handwriting or lower-quality scans, so accuracy is handled deliberately rather than assumed:

Every extracted field comes with a confidence level from the AI, so you can see at a glance which fields it's sure about and which ones are worth double-checking.

Every field is always editable. Nothing is locked in automatically — you can correct any value before it's saved.

A review step is required for every check. No check is saved straight from the AI's reading alone; you always see and confirm the details first, so the final record reflects what's actually on the check, not just what the AI guessed.

The app's pages

New batch (scan and review) — This is the core workflow described above: scan a check or set of checks, let the app read the details automatically, then review, correct, and attribute each one to a fundraiser before saving.

Fundraisers — A running roster of everyone who's brought in checks, each with their running total. Clicking into a name opens their full history — every check they've brought in, with its date, amount, and bank.

Reports — A summary view for recordkeeping: totals broken down by fundraiser, by bank, or by date range, with the option to export everything to a spreadsheet (CSV) for external bookkeeping.

Settings — Where you choose which scanner the app should use, and configure its connection to the AI service that reads the check details.

Scanner compatibility and scope

This app is built to work with scanners that support **TWAIN**, the standard, industry-wide protocol used by the large majority of scanners on Windows — both general document scanners and dedicated check scanners. This covers a broad range of hardware without requiring us to build custom support for each specific model or brand.

Two things worth being explicit about, so expectations are set correctly:

Not every scanner will work. Only scanners with a proper TWAIN driver are supported — a small number of devices with non-standard or proprietary-only interfaces may not connect.

No automatic "good/bad" image-quality flagging. Some specialized, higher-end check-scanning hardware and software can automatically detect and flag scans that are blurry, skewed, or otherwise unusable. This app does not include that feature. Instead, quality control happens through the manual review step — you'll see each scanned check and its image before confirming, and can simply rescan anything that doesn't look right.

In short: we're building on the standard, widely-supported TWAIN capabilities that most scanners offer, rather than proprietary, hardware-specific extensions. That keeps the app broadly compatible across scanner brands, with visual review standing in for automated quality scoring.